

camera stationary, they're hardly useful if, say, you wanted to chase a crawling baby around the house. Shooting video of something that moves is quite tricky, especially if you're trying to shoot steady video while walking. For a steady shot—you guessed it—wheels are involved.

Home-made Dollies

A “camera dolly” is basically a platform that moves on a pair of rails, completed with cameraman sitting on it shooting video and minions who move the platform around at the speed he chooses. At home, you can make your own dolly with something as simple as a sturdy luggage trolley. Actually building tracks in your house might not be such a good idea, but you're welcome to try should the itch hit you. All you need to ensure now is that the trolley's wheels are even and in good condition, and that your floor is fairly smooth. Both these ensure a shake-free video. Get someone to wheel you around, and you have yourself your very own camera dolly! Now you can follow people around or move side by side with them in near-professional style.

More ideas for camera dollies include wheelchairs—Stanley Kubrick's low shots of Danny Torrence on his tricycle in the movie *The Shining* were accomplished using a camera rigged to the bottom of one. Basically, if it's got wheels and won't break under the weight of your camera and/or you, it's got potential.

5.4 Lighting

Like we mentioned before, the wrong lighting can cause your primary subject to be overshadowed by otherwise insignificant elements in the scene. Here's how to work with light.

The Typical Lighting Setup

If you're setting up lighting for indoor shots, there are four different light sources you need to keep in mind: